

Post-Op Instructions: Fillings, Crowns, Bridges and Veneers

After a dental filling, wait until the local anesthesia completely wears off before eating to avoid biting your cheek or tongue. Stick to soft, lukewarm foods for the first 24 hours, manage mild sensitivity with over-the-counter pain relievers, and brush gently.

Immediate Care

- **Wait for numbness to fade.** Do not chew food until you regain full feeling in your lips and tongue.
- **Choose soft foods.** Eat yogurt, scrambled eggs, mashed potatoes, or soup.
- **Avoid extreme temperatures.** Skip very hot drinks or ice-cold foods while the tooth is sensitive.
- **Chew on the opposite side.** Keep food away from the newly filled tooth for the first few days.

What to Avoid

- **Hard or crunchy items.** No nuts, ice, or hard candies that can crack the tooth.
- **Sticky foods.** Avoid caramel, gummy candy, or chewing gum that can pull at the filling.
- **Tobacco and alcohol.** Avoid smoking or drinking alcohol as they irritate healing gums.

Hygiene and Pain Control

- **Take pain relievers.** Use ibuprofen or acetaminophen if you feel mild soreness.
- **Brush and floss gently.** Clean your teeth normally, but use a soft toothbrush and be careful around the filled tooth.

When to Call Your Dentist

- Sensitivity or pain lasts for more than a few days.
- Your bite feels uneven or the filling feels too high when you close your mouth.
- You notice a sharp edge, crack, or the restoration feels loose.

Call (225) 925-2118.

Questions or concerns, call (225) 925-2118. After hours or on weekends, leave a message and someone will return your call shortly. For a medical emergency, including difficulty breathing, call 911 or go to your nearest emergency department.

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